

The first trimester is a crucial time, during which all the major organs are formed. The pregnancy is supported by hormones from the ovary until the placenta takes over at around 10 weeks.

KEY



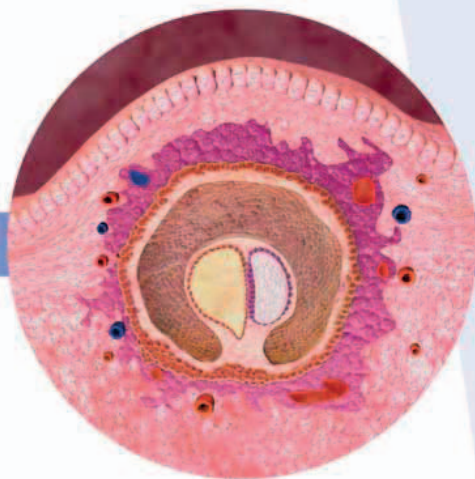
Average height:
Up to 20 weeks crown to rump
From 20 weeks crown to heel



Average weight

4 WEEKS

If you miss a period this week, it could be the first time you wonder, "Am I pregnant?"



Baby watch

Length: $\frac{1}{16}$ in (2 mm)

Your tiny baby has begun life as an embryo and is currently a disc of layered cells that is developing fast. It is floating in a fluid-filled amniotic sac. A basic blood circulation system has been established, and the brain and nervous system have begun to develop.

Mom matters

You might experience a variety of pregnancy symptoms including morning sickness. The levels of human chorionic gonadotrophin (hCG) hormone the fertilized egg is producing are high enough now that a pregnancy test will register positive.



This week...

- » Take a pregnancy test.
- » Start taking 400 mcg folic acid and 10 mcg vitamin D daily, if you aren't already.
- » Find out about stopping your contraception, if your pregnancy wasn't planned.
- » Call your doctor to make an appointment for prenatal care.
- » Stop drinking alcohol, smoking, and keep caffeine to no more than 200 mg per day.

5 WEEKS

You won't be looking pregnant but as your body adapts to the pregnancy, you might well be feeling it.



Baby watch

Length: $\frac{1}{8}$ in (4 mm)

The embryo now resembles a tiny tadpole. The body has lengthened, and a row of dark cells has formed along the back, which is the beginning of the spinal cord. Dark spots on the face are the earliest hints of eyes, and bud like growths will become limbs. The heart is growing fast and by the end of this week it will start beating.

Mom matters

Common first trimester symptoms could be in full swing now. Most of the time they fade after 12 weeks. If you are suffering from morning sickness try eating plain foods and taking ginger. If you can't keep anything down, speak to your doctor.



This week...

- » Learn about what to eat for a healthy pregnancy and avoid foods that can cause food poisoning, such as undercooked egg and meats, pâté and liver, and unpasteurized dairy products and soft cheeses.
- » If you have a hazardous or physically strenuous job, tell your employer about your pregnancy so that he or she can make provisions for you.
- » Think about what type of prenatal care you would like, and compile questions to ask at your first prenatal appointment.

6 WEEKS

Although there is no visible belly bump, it doesn't mean your body isn't changing in other ways.



Baby watch

Length: $\frac{1}{4}$ in (8 mm)

Your baby has doubled in length and resembles a small shrimp. The head and brain are growing at an incredible rate, and dark spots that will develop into eyes have appeared on the sides of the head. Primitive retinas are already forming.

Mom matters

Your metabolism speeds up, your lungs are working harder, and your blood volume is already increasing. Don't be surprised to find a little weight gain already, even though there's no sign of a belly. Your blood pressure drops as your blood vessels relax; this can cause dizziness so try to avoid standing up for long periods. Your nipples and the circles of skin around them (the areolae) may be darker and a mucus plug in the cervix seals off the uterus to protect the baby from infection.



This week...

- » Your first prenatal visit can take place between six and eight weeks of pregnancy. At this appointment you will be weighed and your blood pressure checked. You will have your blood drawn for tests and will leave a urine sample to be checked.
- » You may be given an early ultrasound to check your pregnancy if you have had any bleeding or a previous miscarriage.